



New competitor in the market

HP tries to carve out a slice in the tablet market with its new HP Touchpad and the WebOS it works on

App store a big hit

Apple's revolutionary app store crosses the 15 billion downloads mark

Bazaar mini

LAPTOP



Lenovo IdeaPad U260

Price: ₹44,990

MOBILE PHONE



Huawei Ideos X2

Price: ₹8,990

MOBILE PHONE



Samsung Galaxy Pro

Price : ₹14,120

LAPTOP



ASUS N53Jn

Price : ₹68,999

SPECIFICATIONS

Screen12.5-inch matte, 1366x768
CPU1.3-GHz Intel Core i3-380UM
RAM..... 4GB DDR3
HDD..... 320GB

Quad band GSM, 3G, 3.2-inch TFT display, 320x480 pixel resolution, microSD card slot (up to 32GB), Android 2.1

Quad band GSM, 3G capable, 2.8-inch display, 320x240 pixel resolution, 800MHz processor, Android 2.2, 3.15MP camera, microSD card slot, Android 2.2

Processor: Intel Core i5 M540; Memory: 3GB DDR3 1066MHz; Chipset: Intel HM55 Express; Hard drive: 640GB; Display: 15.6-inch 720p HD

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features.....5.5
Lacking in terms of connectivity ports. Has a low-power processor.

Performance6.0
Basic hardware helps it deliver better performance than a netbook, but not quite close to an average laptop. Two-hour battery.

Build quality6.0
Built well despite being thin. Feels like a premium ultraportable with its finish.

Value for money.....5.5
Priced steeply for a compact laptop with not-so-great performance.

Features.....5.5
Still works on Android 2.1 and lacks WiFi connectivity option. Has a 3.15MP camera.

Performance7.0
Good battery life, the touchscreen responds well and feels solid to hold. QWERTY keypad layout is cramped.

Build quality7.5
Solid build, and looks more expensive than it actually is. Has a slide-out mechanism for battery.

Value for money.....6.5
Price of ₹8.9k is slightly too high for a device that isn't Froyo based.

Features.....7.5
Powerful processor, Android 2.2, touchscreen+ QWERTY combo- this phone is pretty loaded!

Performance7.0
Never assume with the price tag. This one doesn't slow down under the load of multiple apps. Good display as well.

Build quality7.0
Looks plasticky from far, but feels pretty solid to hold. No rough edges as well.

Value for money.....7.5
Touchscreen + QWERTY combo, Android 2.2 and a phone that doesn't slow down.

Features.....7.5
Switchable graphics functionality, a dedicated Wi-Fi on/off switch enhance usability.

Performance7.0
Excellent speaker sound quality. Average display and poor battery-life. Doom 3 and FarCry2 gave favourable scores.

Build quality8.0
Great build quality and appealing design justify expensive price tag.

Value for money.....6.5
Dell XPS 15 in this price range has better display quality.

WE SAY

5.5

This is a thin laptop with a unique form factor - it comes with a 12.5-inch widescreen. It's also extremely light at 1.35 kg and has a stylish, premium, matte screen lid - definitely eye-catching. But the IdeaPad U260 comes with a ULV processor and performs better than a netbook but lower than a mainstream laptop. The laptop does have some useful proprietary software such as VeriFace, OneKey Recovery and YouCam. It offers standard battery performance but overall fails to impress. If only Lenovo improves performance of the U260 with better hardware, it will be an attractive proposition for all.

6.0

At a price of ₹8.9k, the Ideos X2 offers a pretty good display. Offers a combination of good battery life, sure touchscreen response and a solid build quality. However, the device is still stuck in the Android 2.1 ages. And that is a big problem, since there are a lot of rivals out there who will offer the Android 2.2 (Froyo) package for a similar price. And we are pointing specifically at the likes of the Samsung Galaxy Pop, LG Optimus One and HTC Wildfire.

7.5

The Samsung Galaxy Pro is a rare kind of Android phone with a QWERTY keypad. This phone will definitely appeal to those who text/IM/email a lot, and aren't very comfortable with a touchscreen only phone. The Galaxy Pro has a pretty sleek form factor, and the keypad is extremely comfortable to use. But be advised, the display is a bit of a disappointment. If watching a lot of videos is included in your smartphone usage diet, this one isn't for that. At this price, we would recommend this as an alternative for the Blackberry Curve 8520.

7.0

The ASUS N53Jn partly justifies its price tag of ₹68,999 by offering you excellent speaker sound reproduction and great build quality. However, its poor battery-life and an average display will make you look at alternative choices like Dell's XPS 15. So, if you are on a tight budget and yet want the best configuration at the expense of build quality, then the Dell XPS 15 is your best bet. But, if you can afford its steep price, then you may get the ASUS N53Jn.

ALSO SEE:

1) Dell Vostro V130
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